KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 5: CHARTING THE COURSE · WEEK 24 · READING

Nothing but Fish and Fog — Teacher Lesson Plan & Answer Key

Learning objectives: Students make inferences by combining text clues with what they already know and support them with evidence, tell a character trait from a feeling, track how a character changes from the beginning through the turning point to the end, compare how a third-person story and a first-person letter show the same change, and connect the change to the theme.

Duration: 35–45 minutes
Materials: Computer or tablet with the lesson open · pencil · printed Pre & Post sheet

Lesson flow (as it appears on screen)

1. Slide 0 — Intro and name capture: Anya is sure that Sitka, Alaska (on Baranof Island beside Sitka Sound, in the homeland of the Tlingit people), is the most boring town on Earth, until she spends a week on Grandpa Arne's fishing boat. The student types first and last name so results go to KingCretot Experience. Read the scoring rules together: 2 tries per question, Pathway Points only for a correct first try, and the answer plus the reason appear after the 2nd miss. Typed one-word answers ignore capital letters and are accepted when the answer contains an accepted word.
2. Slide 1 — Warm-Up: Week 23 Review (8 pts, 4 each): figurative language and mood.
3. Slide 2 — Pencil Break (Pre): the student opens or prints the Pre/Post sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W24.pdf) and completes Page 1 (Pre-Lesson Warm-Up) on paper before any teaching.
4. Slide 3 — Picture It: Reading Between the Lines. Text clue plus what I know equals an inference, modeled with the short story "The Spelling Bee" (Amos). Track a change: beginning trait, turning point, end trait, theme. A feeling changes quickly; a trait is how a character usually is.
5. Slide 4 — Vocabulary Round-Up: 8 flip cards (inference, character trait, motivation, turning point, character change, theme, slumped, scattered).
6. Slide 5 — Your Turn: Using the Words (8 pts, 4 each): one multiple-choice and one typed vocabulary item.
7. Slide 6 — Text A: The Wrong Screen (5 pts). A third-person story in six paragraphs: Anya calls Sitka boring and ignores an eagle; the fog lifts, a humpback whale rises and she forgets her phone; she lands a coho by herself; she tells her little brother, Arvid, about her day; she is first on the dock and says she was "looking at the wrong screen."
8. Slide 7 — Text B: Anya's Letter (5 pts). A first-person letter to her friend Amina a few weeks later: she takes back "nothing but fish and fog" (mostly), regrets being grumpy, goes to the harbor almost every afternoon, and teaches Arvid.
9. Slide 8 — Tracking Anya's Change (10 pts, 5 each): the traits at the beginning and end, the turning point, and inferences about Grandpa.
10. Slide 9 — Teach: From Change to Theme. Four steps: start (trait and evidence), cause, end (new trait and evidence), lesson (a full sentence about life). Compare a guess with no evidence and a supported inference.

11. Slide 10 — Inference Detective (12 pts, 6 each): pick the best-supported inference and the strongest evidence, and catch the mistakes.
12. Slide 11 — Fix the Sentence, Part 1 (8 pts, 4 each): each item names the one kind of fix. The whole sentence is checked exactly (straight or curly quotes and extra spaces are OK). The corrected sentence appears after the 2nd miss.
13. Slide 12 — Fix the Sentence, Part 2 (8 pts, 4 each): two more sentences, same rules. Titles of stories go in quotation marks, with commas and periods inside.
14. Slide 13 — Back It Up With Evidence (4 pts): quote the story sentence that proves each stage of Anya's change, starting with the tag shown, a comma, and the exact words in quotation marks with the end mark inside. Checked exactly.
15. Slide 14 — Writer's Turn: Explain the Change (6 pts): one typed answer auto-checked by rules: a minimum word count; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (allowed names count as one word); and every key idea included. Feedback names the rule that was missed, and a model answer appears after the 2nd miss. Encourage covering the original before writing.
16. Slide 15 — Match-Up Round (10 pts): character words, story words or Anya's actions matched to meanings or to what they show (a different set each attempt), 2 pts each on the first try.
17. Slide 16 — Speed Trail (bonus XP only): 3 quick questions against the student's own best time.
18. Slide 17 — Boss Challenge (16 pts, 8 each): two-step items across the story and the letter (make the inference or name the trait, then check the evidence).
19. Slide 18 — Pencil Break (Post): the student completes Page 2 (Post-Lesson Activity) of the same sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W24.pdf), including the writing item and the ★ Challenge if time allows, before seeing the score.
20. Slide 19 — Results (Change Tracker!): the score out of 100 is sent to KingCretot Experience. 85 or higher shows "Inference Expert!" with the congratulations message "Inference expert! You read between the lines like a pro!" and a big confetti burst; below 85 shows "Keep Going!" with encouragement ("You're getting closer, and every try makes you stronger."), and the next attempt brings a fresh question set (sets rotate 1, 2, 3). Both messages remind the student to finish the Post-Lesson Challenge sheet.

Lesson answer key with reasoning

Every scored item the student sees, in order, across all three rotating question sets. Each item allows 2 tries and earns Pathway Points only on a correct first try. The "why" is the same reasoning shown on screen after a second missed try.

WARM-UP: WEEK 23 REVIEW (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
`rv1_s0`	Set 1: "The rain drummed its fingers on the boat's roof." What kind of figurative language is this? [Personification / Simile / Hyperbole / Idiom]	**Personification**	Rain does not have fingers and cannot drum them, so the rain is given a human action. That is personification (Week 23).
`rv2_s0`	Set 1: Type your answer: a comparison that says one thing IS another, without using like or as, is called a ___.	**metaphor** (also accepted with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	A comparison without like or as that says one thing is another is a metaphor (Week 23).
`rv1_s1`	Set 2: Which sentence is HYPERBOLE? [This tackle box weighs a thousand pounds! / The fog was as gray as a wet sidewalk. / Grandpa is feeling under the weather today. / The tackle box is heavy.]	**This tackle box weighs a thousand pounds!**	No tackle box weighs a thousand pounds, so that is a huge exaggeration: hyperbole. The others are a simile, an idiom (feeling sick), and a literal sentence (Week 23).

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
rv2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: “cold feet” and “break a leg” are examples of an ___: a common saying whose meaning is different from its words.	**idiom** (also accepted with “a” or “an” or in the plural)	A familiar saying whose meaning you have to learn is an idiom (Week 23).
rv1_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Arden says, “‘The fog was as thick as soup’ is a metaphor.” Which explanation is correct? [It is a simile, because it compares using “as.” / He is right. It is a metaphor. / It is personification, because fog is alive. / It is literal, because fog really is soup.]	**It is a simile, because it compares using “as.”**	A comparison that uses like or as is a simile. A metaphor would say “The fog was soup” (Week 23).
rv2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: the feeling a text creates in the reader, such as tense, peaceful, or joyful, is called the ___.	**mood**	The feeling a text creates in the reader is the mood (Week 23).

YOUR TURN: USING THE WORDS (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
v1_s0	Set 1: From the story: “she slumped in the corner of the boat with her hood pulled tight.” Anya does not want to be there. Using the context, what does slumped most likely mean? [Sat in a tired, droopy way / Jumped up with excitement / Stood tall and proud / Ran quickly across the deck]	**Sat in a tired, droopy way**	Anya is unhappy and hiding in her hood, so she is sitting in a heavy, droopy way. That is what slumped means.
v2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: a smart conclusion you make by combining text clues with what you already know is called an ___.	**inference** (also accepted with “a” or “an” or in the plural)	Text clues plus what you know make an inference.
v1_s1	Set 2: Which explanation of the difference between a feeling and a character trait is correct? [A feeling can change quickly, like being bored; a trait describes how a character usually is, like stubborn or curious. / A feeling and a trait are exactly the same thing. / A trait can only describe how a character looks, like tall or short. / A feeling lasts forever, but a trait changes every minute.]	**A feeling can change quickly, like being bored; a trait describes how a character usually is, like stubborn or curious.**	Feelings come and go. Traits describe a character’s usual way of acting, so a change in a trait is a big change.
v2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: the moment in a story when things begin to change for the main character is called the ___ ___.	**turning point** (also accepted: turning-point)	The moment when change begins is the turning point.
v1_s2	Set 3: From the story: “When the silver coho finally slid into the net, Anya let out a whoop that echoed off the water.” Using the context, what is a whoop? [A loud, excited shout / A quiet, sad sigh / A kind of fishing net / A small wave]	**A loud, excited shout**	Anya has just caught her fish after a hard fight, and the sound echoes off the water. A whoop is a loud shout of excitement.
v2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: a character’s reason for doing something, or what the character wants, is the character’s ___.	**motivation** (also accepted: motive; with “a” or “an” or in the plural)	The reason behind a character’s actions is the motivation.

TEXT A: THE STORY (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
sa_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: in paragraph 1, Anya complains that Sitka has "nothing but fish and ___."	**fog**	Paragraph 1 ends, "Nothing but fish and fog." This shows how Anya feels about her town at the beginning.
sa_s1	Set 2: Paragraph 2: "when Grandpa pointed out a bald eagle on a spruce branch, she didn't even look up." What can you INFER from this clue? [Anya is still unhappy and refuses to enjoy the trip. / Anya cannot see very well without her glasses. / Anya has seen so many eagles that she is an eagle expert. / Grandpa is pointing at the wrong tree.]	**Anya is still unhappy and refuses to enjoy the trip.**	Most people at least glance at a bald eagle. Anya refusing to look up, with her hood pulled tight, shows she has decided not to enjoy anything on the boat.
sa_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: in paragraph 3, what animal rises beside the boat and blows a misty spout?	**whale** (also accepted: humpback, humpback whale; with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	Paragraph 3 says, "A humpback whale rose beside the boat, blew a misty spout, and slid back under the water."

TEXT B: ANYA'S LETTER (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
sb_s0	Set 1: In paragraph 2 of the letter, Anya writes, "I was grumpy for two whole days, and I'm not proud of it." What does this show? [She now regrets how she acted, which shows that she has changed. / She is still grumpy and plans to stay that way. / She is proud of being grumpy. / Grandpa was the one who was grumpy.]	**She now regrets how she acted, which shows that she has changed.**	Saying "I'm not proud of it" means she looks back and wishes she had acted differently. Only someone who has changed would say that.
sb_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: in paragraph 3 of the letter, Anya says she is now teaching someone else what she is learning. Whom is she teaching? Type the name.	**arvid**	Paragraph 3 says, "Grandpa is teaching me to tie knots and read the tide table, and I'm teaching Arvid."
sb_s2	Set 3: The letter ends: "next summer, when you visit, I'm taking you out on the water. There's something I want to show you." What can you INFER Anya wants to show Amina? [The beautiful sights on the water around Sitka, such as whales / Her new phone and its photos of city lights / A fish she bought at the grocery store / The tallest buildings in Seattle]	**The beautiful sights on the water around Sitka, such as whales**	Anya was amazed by the whale and the views from the boat, and she plans to take Amina "out on the water." She wants to share what changed her mind.

TRACKING ANYA'S CHANGE (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qp1_s0	Set 1: Which pair of traits BEST shows how Anya changes from the beginning of the story to the end? [From bored and unwilling to curious and eager / From brave and bold to scared and shy / From kind and caring to mean and selfish / She is exactly the same at the beginning and the end.]	**From bored and unwilling to curious and eager**	At first she calls Sitka boring and refuses to look up. By the end she is first on the dock and sees her town with new eyes, so she has become curious and eager.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qp2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: two steps. In paragraph 1, Anya says there is “nothing to do.” In paragraph 5, when Arvid asks about her day, which word does she open her mouth to say, but then stops?	**nothing**	Paragraph 5 says, “Anya opened her mouth to say ‘nothing,’ then stopped.” She realizes the old answer is no longer true.
qp1_s1	Set 2: In paragraph 4, Anya calls for help, but Grandpa “only kept a steady hand on the net.” Which INFERENCE about Grandpa is correct? [He trusts Anya to land the fish herself, so she can feel proud and capable. / He does not hear her because the boat is too loud. / He wants the fish to get away. / He is too tired to help anyone.]	**He trusts Anya to land the fish herself, so she can feel proud and capable.**	Grandpa says, “You’ve got it.” His words and his calm hands show he believes she can do it, and doing it herself helps change how she feels.
qp2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: two steps. The turning point begins when Anya forgets about her phone. In which paragraph of the story does that happen? Type the paragraph number.	**3** (also accepted: three, third, paragraph 3)	In paragraph 3, the fog lifts, the whale rises, and “Anya’s phone was in her pocket, but she forgot to take it out.” That is the turning point.
qp1_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Ambrose says, “Anya changes because Grandpa makes her promise to stop using her phone.” What is wrong? [The text never says that. She changes because she notices the beauty around her and catches a fish by herself. / Nothing is wrong. Grandpa takes her phone in paragraph 2. / Anya never changes, so there is nothing to explain. / Arvid is the one who takes her phone.]	**The text never says that. She changes because she notices the beauty around her and catches a fish by herself.**	An inference must come from text evidence. Grandpa never mentions her phone. The whale, the mountain, and landing the coho are what change her.
qp2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: two steps. In paragraph 3 of the letter, Anya says Arvid asks her “a thousand questions.” Last week you learned the name for this kind of huge exaggeration. Type it.	**hyperbole** (also accepted with “a” or “an” or in the plural)	Arvid does not really ask a thousand questions. The exaggeration is hyperbole, and it shows he is curious and she is patient with him (Week 23).

INFERENCE DETECTIVE (6 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
d1_s0	Set 1: Paragraph 6: “Anya was the first one on the dock, zipping her rain jacket before Grandpa had even finished his coffee.” Which inference is BEST supported? [Anya is now excited to go out on the boat. / Anya wants to leave Sitka as soon as possible. / Grandpa is too sick to go fishing. / Anya has lost her phone on the dock.]	**Anya is now excited to go out on the boat.**	Getting there first, before Grandpa is even ready, shows eagerness. The other inferences have no evidence in the text.
d2_s0	Set 1: Which theme does Anya’s change BEST show? [Paying close attention can help us see the beauty in something we thought was boring. / Fishing is the best hobby. / Never use a phone. / Salmon are hard to catch.]	**Paying close attention can help us see the beauty in something we thought was boring.**	A theme is a full-sentence message about life that fits beyond the story. “Fishing is the best hobby” is an opinion, “Never use a phone” is a command, and “Salmon are hard to catch” is a fact.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
d1_s1	Set 2: Which evidence BEST supports the inference that Anya has become a patient, caring big sister? [“I’m teaching Arvid. He asks me a thousand questions, and I actually like answering them.” / “I was grumpy for two whole days, and I’m not proud of it.” / “Seattle sounds amazing, and I still miss you every day.” / “Trust me, it smells like old fish.”]	**“I’m teaching Arvid. He asks me a thousand questions, and I actually like answering them.”**	Only the first quotation is about how she treats Arvid. She teaches him and enjoys his questions, which shows patience and care.
d2_s1	Set 2: Anders says, “An inference is just a guess, so any answer is fine.” Which explanation is correct? [No. An inference must be supported by clues in the text plus what you know; a guess with no evidence is not an inference. / Yes. Readers can infer anything they want. / No. An inference must be copied word for word from the text. / Yes. Inferences never use evidence.]	**No. An inference must be supported by clues in the text plus what you know; a guess with no evidence is not an inference.**	An inference goes beyond the exact words, but it must rest on evidence. If nothing in the text supports it, it is only a guess.
d1_s2	Set 3: At the end, Anya says, “I think I was looking at the wrong screen.” What does she mean? [She had been staring at her phone and missing the amazing things all around her in Sitka. / Her phone screen is cracked and needs to be fixed. / She wants a bigger television for her room. / She read the wrong map on Grandpa’s boat.]	**She had been staring at her phone and missing the amazing things all around her in Sitka.**	In paragraph 1 she scrolls through city photos, and in paragraph 3 she forgets her phone while watching a whale. The “wrong screen” was her phone; the right view was the world around her.
d2_s2	Set 3: Which list puts Anya’s change in the correct order? [Calls Sitka boring → ignores the eagle → forgets her phone watching the whale → lands the coho → is first on the dock / Ignores the eagle → is first on the dock → calls Sitka boring → lands the coho → forgets her phone watching the whale / Lands the coho → calls Sitka boring → forgets her phone watching the whale → ignores the eagle → is first on the dock / Is first on the dock → lands the coho → ignores the eagle → calls Sitka boring → forgets her phone watching the whale]	**Calls Sitka boring → ignores the eagle → forgets her phone watching the whale → lands the coho → is first on the dock**	Paragraph 1: she calls Sitka boring. Paragraph 2: she ignores the eagle. Paragraph 3: the whale. Paragraph 4: the coho. Paragraph 6: first on the dock.

FIX THE SENTENCE (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
fs1_s0	Set 1: Title punctuation: put quotation marks around the story’s title. In the story The Wrong Screen, Anya learns to look up.	**In the story "The Wrong Screen," Anya learns to look up.**	The title of a story goes inside quotation marks, and the comma after the title goes inside the closing quotation mark.
fs2_s0	Set 1: Dialogue punctuation: add the missing comma. "You've got it" Grandpa said.	**"You've got it," Grandpa said.**	When the speaker tag comes after the spoken words, a comma goes inside the closing quotation mark.
fs3_s0	Set 1: Comma after an introductory word: add the missing comma. Finally the silver coho slid into the net.	**Finally, the silver coho slid into the net.**	Put a comma after an introductory word like “Finally.”

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
fs4_s0	Set 1: Grammar: fix the verb so it agrees with the subject. Anya and Arvid goes down to the harbor.	**Anya and Arvid go down to the harbor.**	“Anya and Arvid” is a compound subject (two people), so it needs the plural verb “go,” not “goes.”
fs1_s1	Set 2: Commas in a series: add the commas between the three things Anya saw. Anya saw an eagle a whale and a snowy volcano.	**Anya saw an eagle, a whale, and a snowy volcano.** (also accepted: Anya saw an eagle, a whale and a snowy volcano.)	Use commas to separate the three items in a series: an eagle, a whale, and a snowy volcano.
fs2_s1	Set 2: Dialogue capitalization: fix the capital-letter mistake. Arvid begged, "can I come tomorrow?"	**Arvid begged, "Can I come tomorrow?"**	The first word of a quoted sentence is capitalized, even in the middle of your sentence.
fs3_s1	Set 2: Comma after an introductory phrase: add the missing comma. On the third morning the fog lifted.	**On the third morning, the fog lifted.**	Put a comma after an introductory phrase like “On the third morning.”
fs4_s1	Set 2: Grammar: fix the its / it’s mistake. The whale blew mist from it's blowhole.	**The whale blew mist from its blowhole.**	“It’s” means “it is.” The blowhole belongs to the whale, so use the possessive “its” with no apostrophe.
fs1_s2	Set 3: Title capitalization: fix the three capital-letter mistakes in the title. Our lesson is called "nothing but fish and fog."	**Our lesson is called "Nothing but Fish and Fog."**	Capitalize the first word and the important words of a title (Nothing, Fish, Fog), but not short words like “but” and “and” in the middle. The period goes inside the closing quotation mark.
fs2_s2	Set 3: Dialogue punctuation: move the question mark to the right spot. "What did you do all day"? asked Arvid.	**"What did you do all day?" asked Arvid.**	The question mark belongs to the words Arvid asked, so it goes inside the closing quotation mark.
fs3_s2	Set 3: Comma after an introductory word: add the missing comma. Instead she told him about the whale.	**Instead, she told him about the whale.**	Put a comma after an introductory word like “Instead.”
fs4_s2	Set 3: Grammar: fix the their / there / they’re mistake. The fishers tied there boats to the dock.	**The fishers tied their boats to the dock.**	The boats belong to the fishers, so use the possessive “their,” not “there.”

BACK IT UP WITH EVIDENCE (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qt_s0	Set 1: This sentence shows that Anya is still unwilling at the BEGINNING. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text A, paragraph 2): On the first morning, she slumped in the corner of the boat with her hood pulled tight, and when Grandpa pointed out a bald eagle on a spruce branch, she didn’t even look up. Start with: The author writes	**The author writes, "On the first morning, she slumped in the corner of the boat with her hood pulled tight, and when Grandpa pointed out a bald eagle on a spruce branch, she didn't even look up."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word, all three commas, and the apostrophe in “didn’t” inside quotation marks, with the period inside.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qt_s1	Set 2: This sentence shows the TURNING POINT. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text A, paragraph 3): Anya's phone was in her pocket, but she forgot to take it out. Start with: The author writes	**The author writes, "Anya's phone was in her pocket, but she forgot to take it out."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word, the apostrophe, and the comma before "but" inside quotation marks, with the period inside.
qt_s2	Set 3: This sentence shows how eager Anya is at the END. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text A, paragraph 6): On the last morning, Anya was the first one on the dock, zipping her rain jacket before Grandpa had even finished his coffee. Start with: The author writes	**The author writes, "On the last morning, Anya was the first one on the dock, zipping her rain jacket before Grandpa had even finished his coffee."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word and both commas inside quotation marks, with the period inside.

WRITER'S TURN: EXPLAIN THE CHANGE (6 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
wt_s0	Set 1: In one or two sentences, explain how Anya feels about Sitka at the BEGINNING and at the END of the story. Text A, paragraphs 1, 2, and 6: Anya had decided that Sitka, Alaska, was the most boring town on Earth... she slumped in the corner of the boat... On the last morning, Anya was the first one on the dock... she saw her town the way a visitor might... Use at least 18 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the text. (Names like Anya and Sitka are fine.) Name the character: include Anya (or she). Tell the beginning: she thinks Sitka is boring or is unhappy there. Tell the end: she is excited, eager, or amazed by her town. Show the change with a word like but, now, later, or by the end. Original: "Anya had decided that Sitka, Alaska, was the most boring town on Earth. Her best friend, Amina, had moved to Seattle in June, and now Anya spent her afternoons scrolling through photos of city lights while rain tapped on the window. ..." (the full passage is on screen; it is long, so only its opening is shown here)	**Sample:** At first Anya thinks her town is dull and refuses to enjoy the boat trip, but by the end she is eager to go out and sees how beautiful Sitka really is.	A strong answer names Anya, tells how she feels at the beginning (bored, unwilling) and at the end (eager, amazed), and uses a change word to connect them, all in new words. Auto-check rubric: at least 18 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: anya or she; bor or dull or unhappy or grump or hate or disliked or nothing or sulk or annoy or upset or uninterest; excit or love or eager or appreciat or beautiful or amaz or happy or enjoy or proud or wonder or curious or special or glad; end or now or later or last or finally or change or after or became or becomes or then or but.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
wt_s1	Set 2: In one or two sentences, explain the TURNING POINT: what happens in paragraphs 3 and 4 that starts to change Anya? Text A, paragraphs 3–4: On the third morning, the fog lifted. Across Sitka Sound, the snowy cone of Mount Edgecumbe glowed pink in the sunrise. A humpback whale rose beside the boat, blew a misty spout, and slid back under the water. Anya's phone was in her pocket, but she forgot to take it out. She just stared. That afternoon, a fish hit Anya's line so hard that the rod bent nearly in half. She pulled and reeled until her arms burned. "Grandpa, help!" she called. But Grandpa only kept a steady hand on the net. "You've got it," he said. "Slow and steady." When the silver coho finally slid into the net, Anya let out a whoop that echoed off the water. Use at least 18 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the text. (Names like Mount Edgecumbe are fine.) Name the character: include Anya (or she). Include what she sees: the whale or the mountain. Show her reaction: she forgets her phone, stares, or is amazed. Include paragraph 4: she catches the fish (coho or salmon). Original: "On the third morning, the fog lifted. Across Sitka Sound, the snowy cone of Mount Edgecumbe glowed pink in the sunrise. A humpback whale rose beside the boat, blew a misty spout, and slid back under the water. Anya's phone was in her ..." (the full passage is on screen; it is long, so only its opening is shown here)	**Sample:** When the fog clears, Anya sees a glowing volcano and a whale so close that she never thinks about her phone, and later she catches a big salmon by herself.	A strong answer names Anya and both parts of the turning point: seeing the whale and mountain (and forgetting her phone), then catching the coho by herself, all in new words. Auto-check rubric: at least 18 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: anya or she; whale or mountain or edgecumbe or volcano or sunrise; phone or forgot or stare or amaz or wonder or notic or watch; fish or coho or salmon or caught or catch or reel or land.
wt_s2	Set 3: In one or two sentences, state the THEME that Anya's change teaches as a full sentence about life, then give one piece of evidence from the story or the letter. Think about: how Anya felt in paragraph 1, what she noticed in paragraph 3, and what she says in her letter: "I didn't even think about my phone." Use at least 18 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the story or the letter. State the lesson: say something about paying attention, noticing, or looking closely. Say what we can find: beauty, wonder, or something special. Give evidence: mention Anya and a detail such as the whale, her phone, or the dock. Original: "Anya had decided that Sitka, Alaska, was the most boring town on Earth. Her best friend, Amina, had moved to Seattle in June, and now Anya spent her afternoons scrolling through photos of city lights while rain tapped on the window. ..." (the full passage is on screen; it is long, so only its opening is shown here)	**Sample:** When we pay close attention, we can find beauty in places we thought were boring, just as Anya stops staring at her phone and notices the whale.	A strong answer states the theme as a full sentence about life (paying attention reveals beauty or wonder) and backs it up with a detail from the story or letter, in new words. Auto-check rubric: at least 18 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original; must include: attention or notice or look or see or appreciat or open or try; beaut or wonder or special or amaz or value or good or interest or fun; anya or she or whale or phone or dock or letter or fish or coho or arvid.

MATCH-UP ROUND (2 POINTS PER FIRST-TRY MATCH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
match_s0_1	Set 1: Match inference	**text clues plus what you know**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_2	Set 1: Match character trait	**how a character usually is**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_3	Set 1: Match motivation	**the reason a character acts**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_4	Set 1: Match turning point	**the moment change begins**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_5	Set 1: Match theme	**the message about life a story shows**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_1	Set 2: Match slumped	**sat in a tired, droopy way**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_2	Set 2: Match scattered	**spread out over a wide area**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_3	Set 2: Match whoop	**a loud, excited shout**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_4	Set 2: Match steady	**firm and not shaking**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_5	Set 2: Match begged	**asked eagerly, again and again**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_1	Set 3: Match sighs loudly	**shows she is annoyed**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_2	Set 3: Match forgets her phone	**shows she is amazed**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_3	Set 3: Match first on the dock	**shows she is eager**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_4	Set 3: Match teaches Arvid	**shows she is caring**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_5	Set 3: Match “I’m not proud of it”	**shows she feels regret**	2 points if matched on the first try.

BOSS CHALLENGE (8 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
b1_s0	Set 1: Two-step: Step 1, name Anya’s trait at the BEGINNING. Step 2, choose evidence that proves it. Which answer gets BOTH steps right? [Trait: uninterested. Evidence: “she didn’t even look up.” / Trait: uninterested. Evidence: “Anya let out a whoop that echoed off the water.” / Trait: curious. Evidence: “she didn’t even look up.” / Trait: brave. Evidence: “Nothing but fish and fog.”]	**Trait: uninterested. Evidence: “she didn’t even look up.”**	Refusing to look at an eagle shows she is uninterested. The whoop is from later, when she is excited; “curious” does not match the evidence; and complaining about fish and fog does not show bravery.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
b2_s0	Set 1: Two-step: Step 1, choose the theme. Step 2, choose evidence for it from the LETTER. Which answer gets BOTH steps right? [Theme: Paying attention can reveal wonder in a place we thought was boring. Evidence: “I didn’t even think about my phone.” / Theme: Paying attention can reveal wonder in a place we thought was boring. Evidence: “She just stared.” / Theme: Fishing is fun. Evidence: “I didn’t even think about my phone.” / Theme: Big cities are better than small towns. Evidence: “Seattle sounds amazing.”]	**Theme: Paying attention can reveal wonder in a place we thought was boring. Evidence: “I didn’t even think about my phone.”**	The theme is a full sentence about life, and the phone line comes from the letter. “She just stared” supports the theme but comes from the story, not the letter. The other themes are an opinion or the opposite of what Anya learns.
b1_s1	Set 2: Which explanation of how the story and the letter show Anya’s change DIFFERENTLY is correct? [The story uses a third-person narrator who shows her change through actions; the letter lets Anya tell it herself in the first person, including feelings like regret. / Both texts are told by Grandpa. / The story is in the first person and the letter is in the third person. / Neither text shows that Anya changes.]	**The story uses a third-person narrator who shows her change through actions; the letter lets Anya tell it herself in the first person, including feelings like regret.**	In the story, a narrator describes what Anya does (“she slumped,” “Anya was the first one on the dock”). In the letter, Anya writes “I,” so she can tell us her own feelings, such as “I’m not proud of it.”
b2_s1	Set 2: Two-step: Step 1, decide what Grandpa does that helps Anya change. Step 2, decide what it shows about him. Which answer gets BOTH right? [He invites her on the boat and lets her land the fish herself; it shows he is patient and believes in her. / He takes away her phone; it shows he is strict. / He reels in the fish for her; it shows he is impatient. / He ignores her all week; it shows he does not care.]	**He invites her on the boat and lets her land the fish herself; it shows he is patient and believes in her.**	Grandpa asks her to help, points out the eagle, and says “You’ve got it” instead of grabbing the rod. That shows patience and trust. The other choices are not in the text.
b1_s2	Set 3: Which NEW story shows the SAME kind of character change and theme as Anya’s? [A boy thinks his grandmother’s garden is boring, but after a week of helping, he notices hummingbirds and the first ripe tomatoes and starts asking to visit. / A girl practices basketball every day and makes the team. / A lost dog finds its way home after a storm. / Two sisters argue over a toy and then forgive each other.]	**A boy thinks his grandmother’s garden is boring, but after a week of helping, he notices hummingbirds and the first ripe tomatoes and starts asking to visit.**	Like Anya, the boy starts out bored, begins to notice the wonders around him, and becomes eager. The other stories teach hard work, survival, and forgiveness.
b2_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Armando writes, “At the end, Anya still thinks Sitka is boring, because she writes ‘Mostly’ in her letter.” Which explanation is correct? [He ignores most of the evidence. She goes to the harbor almost every afternoon and wants to show Amina the water; “Mostly” is a small, joking way of admitting she has changed her mind. / He is right. “Mostly” proves she has not changed at all. / He is wrong only because the letter is written to Arvid. / He is wrong because Anya moves to Seattle at the end.]	**He ignores most of the evidence. She goes to the harbor almost every afternoon and wants to show Amina the water; “Mostly” is a small, joking way of admitting she has changed her mind.**	A strong inference weighs ALL the evidence. One playful word cannot outweigh her trips to the harbor, teaching Arvid, and wanting to share the water with her friend.

Pre & Post sheet answer guide

Many items are open-ended. Grade for genuine understanding and complete sentences, not exact wording. Sheet: grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W24.pdf.

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Review: “The wind howled at the windows all night.”	Personification: the wind is given a living creature’s action. It really means the wind blew hard and loudly all night.
2	How does Arden feel? Which clues?	Angry or upset. Clues: he stomped in, dropped his muddy boots by the door, and would not look at anyone.
3	Which word is a character trait?	Generous
4	A character who changes: start and end	Answers vary. Check that the student names the character and gives a trait at the start and a different trait at the end.
5	Something “boring” in your town, seen by a visitor	Answers vary. Look for one sentence that notices something interesting or beautiful about a familiar place.

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Anya wrinkles her nose, then rolls up her sleeves: inference and clue	Model: Anya thinks cleaning the fish is gross, but she is willing to do it anyway. Clues: she wrinkled her nose (disgust), then she rolled up her sleeves (getting ready to work).
2	Anya at the beginning, what changes her, and at the end	Model: At the beginning, Anya is bored and unwilling; she calls Sitka “nothing but fish and fog” and will not look up at the bald eagle. She changes when the fog lifts and a humpback whale rises beside the boat, so she forgets her phone, and then she lands a coho by herself. At the end, she is curious and eager; she is the first one on the dock and sees her town “the way a visitor might.”
3	Anders says Grandpa is angry because he will not help reel in the fish	Model: The inference is wrong because the evidence shows trust, not anger. Grandpa keeps a steady hand on the net and says, “You’ve got it” and “Slow and steady.” He lets Anya land the fish herself because he believes she can do it.
4	Be the editor	a) However, Anya forgot her phone. b) Arvid asked, "Can you show me the whale?"

★ CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Show (do not tell) how Arvid changes on his first day on the boat	Answers vary. Grading note: 3 or 4 sentences that show the change through Arvid’s actions, words or reactions (for example, he grips the rail at first, then leans over to watch a whale and begs to steer) instead of naming the feeling.